

EL — The Elev8 Character Bible

02100 — for Elev8

01. WHO SHE IS, IN ONE LINE

El was drawn from the same line as you.

She's a bunny. She's Elev8's mascot. And she's not decoration — she's the "8" in the logo, stepped out to say hello.

02. THE NAME

El. Short for Elev8.

A name a five-year-old and a fifty-year-old say the same way, first try, in any language. No meaning to explain, no pronunciation guide, no cultural weight to unpack in a market this diverse. She's a bunny, and "El" reads instantly as a name, not an acronym or a concept dressed up as one.

03. THE ORIGIN STORY

Long form — brand book / About page

Before "8," there was a line.

Look closely at the Elev8 logotype and you'll find it: the "8" is one unbroken line, looped twice. That same loop runs through you too — it's the shape of your nervous system in miniature, the line every signal in your body travels along, from your brain to the very tips of your fingers.

El was drawn from that line.

When you need her, the loop in the "8" gently unwinds, dips beneath the surface, and opens a small hole in the page — not fixed, not flat, but soft and round,

opening wherever it's needed, whenever it's needed. And EI pops up through it: ears first, then those calm, curious eyes.

She's not arriving from somewhere else. She was already in the line. She's just stepping out to say hello.

EI doesn't do the work for you, and she doesn't lecture you either. She just quietly makes sure that whatever you're looking at — a heart panel, a meal plan, a milestone you just hit — you don't have to look at it alone.

Short form — sits directly under the hero, ~55 words

The "8" in Elev8 is one unbroken line, looped twice — the same shape as your nervous system in miniature.

EI was drawn from that line. When you need her, the loop unwinds, opens a small hole in the page, and she pops up — ears first, then those calm, curious eyes. She was already there. She's just saying hello.

The one-liner

"EI was drawn from the same line as you."

04. CHARACTER TRAITS

What EI is: calm, warm, and specifically glad to see you. She emerges — a slow, soft pop, ears rising before anything else — like she's been patiently waiting just under the surface for the right moment.

What EI is not: hyper, slapstick, or performing for an audience. No bouncing, no flailing, no exaggerated cartoon joy. Her register is "a good friend who's genuinely pleased with your progress," not "a mascot doing a bit." This is a health brand — the warmth has to survive a cancer-risk panel sitting right next to a fitness one.

Five behaviours:

1. **She emerges, she doesn't appear.** Every entrance starts with the hole opening, then ears, then eyes. Never a hard cut, never a pop-in.
2. **She recedes when she's not needed.** No lingering, no hovering at the edge of every screen. She shows up for a reason and goes back into the line.

3. **She reshapes around the moment, never the words.** Ears into a heart, head into an apple, body into a thumbs-up — she adapts her *form* to context, but her construction (outline weight, fill, proportions, expression register) never changes.
4. **She never reacts to bad news with a face.** No frowns, no worried expressions, no drama. Difficult information is delivered by the copy around her, not by EI's expression.
5. **The hole moves, not just EI.** The opening she emerges from can appear anywhere on a page, at any scale, in any layout — it's not a fixed graphic bolted to one corner. It opens only for the moment it's needed, and closes after. Think of it as 4D: it exists in time as much as in space.

Voice, if EI ever speaks (Phase 3 app companion):

- Short, warm, plain sentences. No exclamation-mark enthusiasm.
 - Never diagnoses. Always points to a human when it matters.
 - Sample: *"Your last three check-ins were all on the same afternoon slot — want me to just block that time out for you every week?"*
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05. THE KEYSTONE MECHANIC — the logo is where she lives

The "8" in Elev8 is EI's line, coiled.

The wordmark's 8 is one unbroken loop. On page load — or whenever a new EI moment is needed — that loop gently unwinds, sinks into a soft round hole that opens in the page, and EI rises up through it, ears first. When she's done, she steps back down and the loop re-forms into the logotype.

This is the single idea worth remembering above everything else in this document:

- EI isn't a bolted-on character — she's *literally drawn from the brand mark itself*. That's genuinely rare, ownable brand mechanics, not decoration.
 - The hole is reusable everywhere: loading states, empty states, section transitions, milestone moments — a system, not a one-off animation.
 - The logo, the loader, and the mascot are three views of one asset.
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06. COLOUR

EI gets her own palette, deliberately softer than Elev8's core brand system — so she reads as *approachable* first, *branded* second.

Token	Hex	Name	Job
Outline	#E8A79C	Petal	El's line, always. Soft, warm, calming pastel red-rose.
Fill	#FBF3EC	Cream	El's body and face fill. Warm off-white, never stark.
The hole	#4A3B3F	Warm Plum	Deep, soft, warm dark tone — never pure black. Keeps every scene gentle rather than stark.

Rule: Petal is never used as a UI action colour, and Elev8's primary saturated brand red (used for CTAs) is never used on El. Keeping the two reds distinct is what lets El feel safe to look at even when she's sitting next to serious content.

07. CONSTRUCTION RULES

OUTLINE Every part of El — ears, head, arms — is a distinct, fully closed

shape, drawn with two parallel contour lines (an outer curve and an inner curve) giving consistent, even width throughout, like a rounded ribbon. Never a single thin center-stroke line standing in for a limb — that's what causes limbs to visually fuse.

No tapering. Fully rounded caps and joins.

Optical scale: roughly 6–7% of El's head width, held constant at every size.

MERGING Ears, arms, and other limbs stay individually closed shapes even when a pose brings them close together (e.g. the Heart pose).

Two separate symmetric shapes reading as one silhouette is correct; one shape doing double duty as two limbs is not — it produces lopsided, asymmetric results and is the single most common construction error to check for in any new pose.

FILL El's body and face: Cream, always. The hole: Warm Plum, always.

Flat fill only — no gradients on either.

CONSTRUCTION Same silhouette logic every time: rounded head, two tall rounded ears, small dot eyes, small dot nose. Reshaping happens at the ears / limbs / silhouette level — the base unit never breaks.

EXPRESSION Calm register only: content, curious, gently proud. No fear, anger, or exaggerated surprise, ever.

COLOUR Petal outline, Cream fill, Warm Plum hole. Never swapped with Elev8's primary CTA red.

THE HOLE Round, soft-edged, Warm Plum. Can open at any scale or position in a layout, but is always the same shape and colour. It opens, holds, and closes — never a static decorative element.

DON'T No hard-edged pop-ins. No slapstick poses. No sharp corners anywhere on El. No expressions outside the calm register.

No reusing Petal as a UI action colour.

08. EL'S POSES — GESTURE, NOT RESHAPING

Strategy correction, locked after testing: El's body never reshapes into an unrelated object. Full ears, full silhouette, every time — only her *gesture and expression* change. Asking one silhouette to be both "recognisably El" and "recognisably a heart" is asking two jobs of one shape, and one always loses. This is the same reason Headspace's Ebb never turns into a moon for "sleep soundly" — the mascot stays the mascot, and category meaning is carried by a separate system (see §09).

Pose	Use	What changes
Neutral	Default state, wherever El is simply present	Ears up, at ease, hands resting on the hole's edge
Waiting / Loading	Any wait state, page transition, report generation	El stays fully herself, calm and patient; a small separate abstract spinner (drawn in her line colour, not part of her body) appears beside her
Thinking	Data processing, "we're working on your results" moments	One ear tilts as a natural gesture — never reshaped — paw at chin, eyes cast up and to the side
Thumbs up	Milestone completion, a goal hit, a habit kept	Fully emerged from the hole, one paw raised in a thumbs-up, warm proud expression

09. THE VERTICAL ICON SYSTEM — separate from El, by design

Each of the six panels/verticals gets its own small, simple, **abstract** icon — not a literal pictogram, and not a version of El. This is deliberate: literal shapes (a heart, an apple) are genuinely harder to render symmetrically than abstract marks, and a mascot has no business trying to double as a diagram. **Confirmed set, first render approved:**

Vertical	Colour token	Mark	One-liner caption
MOVE	Kalava (coral)	Swoosh	Every rep, every stride — one upward line.
CLEAR	Signal Blue (indigo)	Spiral	The line stress takes, before you catch it.
LONG	Amber	Solid circle	A whole, steady state, held over time.
FUEL	Jade	Leaf blob	Shaped by what you actually eat.
KNOW	Orchid	Dotted squiggle	Every point, connected — your family's pattern.
LOOK	Sea (teal)	Droplet	One clear read on skin and hair.

These sit next to category labels exactly as Headspace does it — icon, label, chevron. The one-liners are a second, shorter layer of copy for hover states or a standalone system slide — distinct from the fuller panel taglines used on the landing page itself. El does not appear in this system at all; she lives in the hero, loading states, and milestone moments, never as a stand-in for a data category.

One open flag from the first render: the spiral for CLEAR sits close to a well-known meditation app's own "manage anxiety" icon. Worth a second pass before final lock, so the set reads as genuinely original rather than adjacent to an existing brand's marks.

Why each shape — the deeper layer

A third tier of copy, one level past the one-liner: the actual design logic behind each mark. Held back from default view — see landing page §04 for where and how this surfaces.

Icon	Category	Why this shape	Full explainer
Swoosh (coral)	MOVE	An upward stroke, mid-arc — the shape of a stride, a jump, a rep completed.	Everything that moves you — sport, strength, recovery, injury risk. The

Icon	Category	Why this shape	Full explainer
		Nothing about it is resting.	swoosh is motion caught mid-air, the same shape as a stride or a single completed rep.
Spiral (indigo)	CLEAR	A spiral unwinds from a tight centre outward — the physical shape of a thought loosening its grip.	Sleep, stress, and the head between them. The spiral is a thought mid-unwind — tight at the centre, looser toward the edge, the shape your mind takes when it finally lets go.
Circle (amber)	LONG	A complete, unbroken form. No start, no end — nothing partial about it.	Hormones, ageing, the decades ahead. A circle has no beginning and no finish line — it's the shape of something sustained, not something you complete once.
Leaf blob (jade)	FUEL	The one organic shape in the set — grown, not drawn with a ruler.	What you eat, how your gut handles it, how your metabolism responds. Food isn't mechanical, so its icon isn't either.
Dotted squiggle (orchid)	KNOW	A trail of individual points forming one connected path — data markers, strung into a pattern.	Cancer risk, cardiovascular risk, what runs in the family. Each dot is a single marker; strung together, they trace a pattern only visible in aggregate — exactly

Icon	Category	Why this shape	Full explainer
			how genetic risk gets read.
Droplet (teal)	LOOK	The simplest unit of something clear and concentrated. One drop, one clean answer.	Skin and hair, decided by chemistry. A single droplet instead of a dozen guesses.

10. WHERE SHE SHOWS UP

Preloader (every page) · Hero (peeking in from the edge) · Loading and empty states · Report-ready notifications · Milestone and streak moments in-app · Section transitions on the marketing site · Kit packaging (as a small emerging silhouette, not the full brand mark) · Email footer · 404 page, doing something gently funny with the "page not found" hole joke, once, in exactly one place.

Where she does not show up: anywhere near a genuinely serious result (a positive cancer-risk marker, for instance). That's a human moment. EI steps back for those, on purpose — restraint here is not a limitation, it's the brand keeping its promise that she's not performing.
